

influence. Meanwhile court life was enhanced by a sexual liaison with a young Italian mezzo-soprano, Luigia Polzelli, carried on with the connivance of her husband.

In 1790, Prince Nikolaus Esterházy died and his successor, Prince Anton, was uninterested in maintaining an expensive musical establishment. Although still on the Esterházy payroll, Haydn found himself with no orchestra and little to do. Musical impresario Johann Peter Salomon (see box) was eager to engage a composer whose work was famous but who had never been seen by the public. He enlisted Haydn for a series of concerts in London in 1791.



ESTERHAZA PALACE

In 1766–1790, Haydn lived in a four-room apartment in servant's quarters near the main Esterháza palace. The remoteness of the palace led to boredom among his musicians, but allowed Haydn time to develop his compositions.

Triumph in London

Haydn's arrival in music-mad London caused "a great sensation." He was wined and dined, met the king, went to the races, received an honorary doctorate from Oxford University, and